8. Configuring User Management and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator Application

Aim

To configure user management and role-based access control (RBAC) in a Zoho Creator application by adding users, assigning them suitable roles and permissions, and managing their active or inactive status, so that each user can access only the data and features they are authorised to use.

Theory

1. User Management

User management is the process of adding, organising and controlling the people who can access an application. In Zoho Creator, a user is an individual who has been granted access to the solutions through a role-based access control mechanism. Users are invited by email address, and each user has a status (Active or Inactive) that decides whether they can sign in and work with the application. Deactivating a user withdraws access without deleting the account.

2. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

RBAC is a security model in which access rights are assigned to roles rather than to individual users. Each user is then given one or more roles, and inherits the permissions of those roles. This keeps access consistent, makes administration simpler, and follows the principle of least privilege, where users get only the access needed to do their work.

3. Key Components in Zoho Creator

Component	Description
Super Admin	The account owner, with complete control over the account, its applications, users and billing.
Administrator	A user who can manage applications and other users within the account.
Role	Defines a user's position in the organisation hierarchy and influences which records they can see.
Profile / Permissions	Defines what a user can do with forms, reports and pages, such as view, create, edit, delete or export.
User Status	Active users can access the application; Inactive users are blocked until reactivated.

4. How Access Control Works

- The administrator adds a user by entering the email address and choosing the user type and role.
- The user accepts the invitation and signs in with their own account.
- The assigned role and permissions control which forms, reports and pages the user can see and what actions they can perform.

- The administrator can change a role or mark the user Inactive at any time, and the change takes effect immediately.

5. Benefits of RBAC

- Protects sensitive data by limiting access to authorised users only.
- Reduces administrative effort, since permissions are managed per role instead of per user.
- Improves accountability and supports compliance and audit requirements.
- Makes it easy to onboard, change or remove users as responsibilities change.

Screenshots

